Nicole Esther Lee

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Dear OKDS team,

My favourite part of any project is designing something, then making it real through code. I'm Nicole, and I'm studying for a Bachelor of Science in Computer Science in Interactive Media and Game Development at the Singapore Institute of Technology and DigiPen Institute of Technology. Programming isn't my strongest skill yet, so AI is my bestie: it helps me build what I design, while I stay the one checking every decision. That's why "the operating system between human intent and AI-generated output" is the most exciting job description I've read this year. I'd love to help build it as your Design System Designer.

Here's how my work maps to OKDS:

- **Foundations: Tick, a design system for a crypto trading app.** I built primitive-to-semantic tokens for colour, spacing and radius, with Light/Dark and Green-up/Red-up market modes. The core rule was "separate value from intent", so a red price drop never looks like an error. I use the same colour rules across all my files: brand, neutral and semantic palettes from 50 to 900, no pure black or white, and dark modes built by desaturating colours and lightening raised surfaces.
- **Components: Makan Kaki.** 15 core components with clear naming, variants and states, plus tokens that re-skin the same app into five visual styles without moving a single layout. Each style has its own style sheet, and every design decision is logged with its trade-off.
- **AI tooling, with human judgment.** I let Figma's AI agent do the first pass on Tick, then reviewed its output and logged every defect with before-and-after evidence: clipped variants, wrong totals, crossed order-book data. I built my portfolio with Claude Code, and used scripts to audit spacing across every page and every Figma screen. AI does the volume; I check whether it's right.
- **Designers and engineers as users.** For a school module, I built a Unity-style level editor on our team's C++ engine so two design students could build a Windows and Android game without touching engine code. On another module, Chroma, I ended up organising the 8-person team's tasks and bridging what our designer needed with what the programmers built.

I also know why reliability matters when money moves. I'm a Site Reliability Engineer intern in Global Financial Markets Technology at DBS Bank, where I automate operations and run UAT before releases. A design system for a crypto exchange needs that same care: every state accounted for, nothing ambiguous on a trade screen.

I can start full-time from April 2027. You can see my work, and how I think through it, at nicoleesther.github.io/design. I'd love to chat about OKDS, and maybe trade notes on the perfect shade of "price up" green.

Thank you for reading,

Nicole Esther Lee